SYNTHETIC GRAPH SOURCE {COUNT} $&

Before you buy or start

Use your farm observations and the research shortlists. Confirm choices locally before buying.

Research climate group: Growing area not resolved. This grouping is not a validated recommendation for this farm.

What you reported about this farm

Water through the dry season

Not recorded. Complete the site survey and confirm water before choosing an intensive plan.

Frost on this farm

Local frost observations are not recorded. Satellite monthly averages cannot establish first and last frost dates.

Sun and drainage

Sun: not recorded.

Drainage: not recorded. Soil-test results and crop-specific needs still need checking.

Reporting-year records - not a forecast

Past reporting-year totals and months describe what was reported. They do not promise food in the coming plan.

Original eggs {year} $&

Farmer-reported annual total for 2025: 240 eggs.

Household use: 0 eggs. Sold: not recorded.

Reported harvest months: Jun, Jul. These are survey observations, not a new production forecast.

Check the recorded unit and totals before using this row.

Fish

Farmer-reported annual total for 2025: not recorded.

Household use: not recorded. Sold: not recorded.

Reported harvest months: not recorded. These are survey observations, not a new production forecast.

Check the recorded unit and totals before using this row.

Other vegetables

Farmer-reported annual total for 2025: 12 kg.

Household use: 7 kg. Sold: 3 kg.

Reported harvest months: Jan, Dec. These are survey observations, not a new production forecast.

Check the recorded unit and totals before using this row.

SYNTHETIC GRAPH SOURCE {COUNT} $&

Farm choices - continued

Use your farm observations and the research shortlists. Confirm choices locally before buying.

Animal products and care

Goats: Dairy goat (Saanen / Toggenburg / British Alpine)

1 existing; 2 proposed structure(s). Selected enterprise: milk. No animal head count or output is assumed.

Buying advice: match breed/stock to the product, local feed, climate and care capacity; confirm with a local livestock or beekeeping adviser.

Plan around actual calving/kidding and lactation. Dry animals do not supply milk.

Time to first product: not sourced for this enterprise.

Production reference: 775.4-1073.4 kg milk/doe/305-day lactation. Lowest (>=7th parity) and highest (3rd parity) group means for milk yield per 305-day standardised lactation in 16,407 analysed South African ARC Saanen lactation records, 1955-2018, mostly intensive/semi-intensive stud herds. Original PDF Table 3 labels the last group >=7th; HTML renders it >7th. Kept in kg, without litres conversion, annualisation or yield-by-age interpolation.

Age/system reference: South African Saanen reference by lactation number, not age in years: mean milk mass per standardised 305-day lactation was 947.3 kg at first parity, 1043.2 at second, 1073.4 at third, 1020.3 at fourth, 972.8 at fifth, 901.6 at sixth and 775.4 at >=7th. These ARC milk-recorded groups were mostly intensive/semi-intensive stud herds. Record actual kidding date, lactation number and collected milk; do not divide these totals evenly into months.

Age/system reference: At Putukwane near Polokwane, 179 lactating does under extensive feeding with irregular supplementation were observed for 210 days after kidding. Mean milk mass was 1.45 kg/day for Saanen, 0.75 for British Alpine and 0.56 for Toggenburg during observed lactation. Early lactation exceeded mid and late lactation; March-April kidding outperformed October-November in this cohort. These conditions differ from stud-herd records. Discuss adapted stock and feed locally; these are not litres/day or year-round promises.

Check the detailed enterprise references for feed and housing. Match the ration and space to the animal stage and housing system; provide dependable clean water.

It is an offence to keep a goat somewhere with inadequate space, ventilation, light or shelter from heat, cold or weather, or to confine/tether it in a way that causes unnecessary suffering.

It is an offence to starve, under-feed, or deny water or food to a goat.

An owner must not let a goat stay in a dirty or parasite-infested condition, and must get veterinary or other treatment for a sick, injured or diseased animal when able to.

Foot-and-mouth disease (FMD) is a controlled animal disease under the Animal Diseases Act: veterinary services enforce isolation and movement restrictions, and a suspected case must be reported.

Inside a declared FMD-affected zone, goats and their products (including milk) cannot be moved into, out of, or within the zone without a state veterinary movement permit and compliance with its conditions.

Every goat owner must register an official identification mark and mark their goats with it, under the Animal Identification Act.

A goat may only be slaughtered for sale at a registered abattoir under the Meat Safety Act (relevant when culled dairy does or male kids are sold for meat); slaughtering for the farmer's own consumption, or for cultural/religious purposes, is exempt but that meat may not then be sold.

Source: Animals Protection Act 71 of 1962, s.2(1)(b), p. 1

Source: Animals Protection Act 71 of 1962, s.2(1)(c), p. 1

Source: Animals Protection Act 71 of 1962, s.2(1)(e), p. 1

Source: SAnews: KZN Foot and Mouth Disease boundaries extended (Dept of Agriculture statement)

Source: Animal Identification Act 6 of 2002, s.7(1), p. 4

Source: Meat Safety Act 40 of 2000, s.7(2)(a), p. 6

Source: Malemela, Nemutandani & Tada (2024), South African Saanen goats, Table 3, p. 625

Source: Norris et al. (2011), Milk Production of Three Exotic Dairy Goat Genotypes in Limpopo Province, South Africa: methods, results and Table 2

SYNTHETIC GRAPH SOURCE {COUNT} $&

Farm choices - continued

Use your farm observations and the research shortlists. Confirm choices locally before buying.

Animal products and care (continued)

Goats: Dairy goat (Saanen / Toggenburg / British Alpine) (continued)

Source: Malemela, Nemutandani & Tada (2024), South African Saanen goats: Table 3, 305-day milk yield by parity, p. 625

Goats: Indigenous veld / communal goat (e.g. Nguni, Tankwa, Xhosa lob-ear)

1 existing; 2 proposed structure(s). Selected enterprise: meat. No animal head count or output is assumed.

Buying advice: match breed/stock to the product, local feed, climate and care capacity; confirm with a local livestock or beekeeping adviser.

First product reference: 69.6-78.3 weeks. This is age at first KIDDING (birth of first kids), not first weaned kids. 16 months x 4.35 = 69.6 weeks; 18 months x 4.35 = 78.3 weeks, from doe birth to her giving birth for the first time. Adding the source's own ~150-day (~5-month, ~21.75-week) weaning assumption would put first WEANED kids at roughly 91-100 weeks of doe age, but that compound figure is not shown as the primary value since the field is documented as 'age/time from start (hatch, birth) to first product' and first kidding is the clearer, directly-stated milestone; the weaning offset is noted here for transparency.

Age/system reference: The 2016 government goat manual distinguishes indigenous, Boer, Savanna and Kalahari Red meat-purpose stock from milk/fibre breeds, with breeding objectives and individual birth, weaning, weight and sale records. Uncontrolled communal mating can produce births at any time; that does not establish meat or weaned-kid availability all year. Choose stock for the local system and record survival and product stage before forecasting quantities.

Age/system reference: In KZN Highland Sourveld smallholder systems, winter and early-spring feed shortage can restrict goats. Autumn-kidding does feed kids through winter; spring-kidding does face late-pregnancy feed shortage, especially with late rains. Plan local winter feed and monitor weights with extension support; this is regional care context, not kg or a universal kidding calendar.

Check the detailed enterprise references for feed and housing. Match the ration and space to the animal stage and housing system; provide dependable clean water.

It is an offence to keep a goat somewhere with inadequate space, ventilation, light or shelter from heat, cold or weather, or to confine/tether it in a way that causes unnecessary suffering.

It is an offence to starve, under-feed, or deny water or food to a goat.

An owner must not let a goat stay in a dirty or parasite-infested condition, and must get veterinary or other treatment for a sick, injured or diseased animal when able to.

Winter feed shortage on communal sourveld is a known welfare/production risk: does that kid in autumn must feed kids through winter, and does that kid in spring suffer poor nutrition during late pregnancy, so winter feed supplementation matters.

Foot-and-mouth disease (FMD) is a controlled animal disease under the Animal Diseases Act: veterinary services enforce isolation and movement restrictions, and a suspected case must be reported.

Inside a declared FMD-affected zone, goats and their products cannot be moved into, out of, or within the zone without a state veterinary movement permit and compliance with its conditions.

Every goat owner, including communal/smallholder owners, must register an official identification mark and mark their goats with it, under the Animal Identification Act.

A goat may only be slaughtered for sale at a registered abattoir under the Meat Safety Act; slaughtering it for the farmer's own consumption, or for cultural/religious purposes (including ceremonial slaughter, common with indigenous goats), is exempt from that rule, but that meat may not then be sold.

Source: Animals Protection Act 71 of 1962, s.2(1)(b), p. 1

Source: Animals Protection Act 71 of 1962, s.2(1)(c), p. 1

Source: Animals Protection Act 71 of 1962, s.2(1)(e), p. 1

Source: Letty, B. & Madiba, S., KZN DARD. Constraints to Small-Scale Goat Production in the Highland Sourveld Area of KwaZulu-Natal, p. 3

Source: SAnews: KZN Foot and Mouth Disease boundaries extended (Dept of Agriculture statement)

SYNTHETIC GRAPH SOURCE {COUNT} $&

Farm choices - continued

Use your farm observations and the research shortlists. Confirm choices locally before buying.

Animal products and care (continued)

Goats: Indigenous veld / communal goat (e.g. Nguni, Tankwa, Xhosa lob-ear) (continued)

Source: Animal Identification Act 6 of 2002, s.7(1), p. 4

Source: Meat Safety Act 40 of 2000, s.7(2)(a), p. 6

Source: DAFF (2016), Goat Training Manual: breeds p2, records pp4-5, uncontrolled mating section 2.4.6 p7, p. 7

Source: KZN DARD: Goat Production in KwaZulu-Natal, Highland Sourveld research and winter nutrition

Source: Webb, E.C. & Mamabolo, M.J. (2004). Production and reproduction characteristics of South African indigenous goats in communal farming systems. S. Afr. J. Anim. Sci. 34(5):236-239

SYNTHETIC GRAPH SOURCE {COUNT} $&

Farm choices - continued

Use your farm observations and the research shortlists. Confirm choices locally before buying.

Animal products and care (continued)

Goats: Boer goat (meat enterprise)

1 existing; 2 proposed structure(s). Selected enterprise: meat. No animal head count or output is assumed.

Buying advice: match breed/stock to the product, local feed, climate and care capacity; confirm with a local livestock or beekeeping adviser.

Time to first product: not sourced for this enterprise.

Production reference: 1.5 kids weaned/doe mated. The reported weaning rate is 149%, or 1.49 kids weaned per doe mated. The source describes observations over twenty years for extensive Boer does at 295 mm rainfall; it does not state kids weaned per doe per calendar year. This is a reproductive outcome, not kg of live animals or dressed meat. A separate mean litter size of 1.93 kids born per parturition has a different denominator and stage and is not merged into this figure.

Age/system reference: The 2016 government goat manual distinguishes indigenous, Boer, Savanna and Kalahari Red meat-purpose stock from milk/fibre breeds, with breeding objectives and individual birth, weaning, weight and sale records. Uncontrolled communal mating can produce births at any time; that does not establish meat or weaned-kid availability all year. Choose stock for the local system and record survival and product stage before forecasting quantities.

Check the detailed enterprise references for feed and housing. Match the ration and space to the animal stage and housing system; provide dependable clean water.

It is an offence to keep a goat somewhere with inadequate space, ventilation, light or shelter from heat, cold or weather, or to confine/tether it in a way that causes unnecessary suffering.

It is an offence to starve, under-feed, or deny water or food to a goat.

An owner must not let a goat stay in a dirty or parasite-infested condition, and must get veterinary or other treatment for a sick, injured or diseased animal when able to.

Foot-and-mouth disease (FMD) is a controlled animal disease under the Animal Diseases Act: veterinary services enforce isolation and movement restrictions, and a suspected case must be reported.

Inside a declared FMD-affected zone, goats and their products cannot be moved into, out of, or within the zone without a state veterinary movement permit and compliance with its conditions.

Every goat owner must register an official identification mark and mark their goats with it, under the Animal Identification Act.

A goat may only be slaughtered for sale at a registered abattoir under the Meat Safety Act; slaughtering it for the farmer's own consumption, or for cultural/religious purposes, is exempt from that rule, but that meat may not then be sold.

Source: Animals Protection Act 71 of 1962, s.2(1)(b), p. 1

Source: Animals Protection Act 71 of 1962, s.2(1)(c), p. 1

Source: Animals Protection Act 71 of 1962, s.2(1)(e), p. 1

Source: SAnews: KZN Foot and Mouth Disease boundaries extended (Dept of Agriculture statement)

Source: Animal Identification Act 6 of 2002, s.7(1), p. 4

Source: Meat Safety Act 40 of 2000, s.7(2)(a), p. 6

Source: DAFF (2016), Goat Training Manual: breeds p2, records pp4-5, uncontrolled mating section 2.4.6 p7, p. 7

Source: King, F.J.M. (2009). Production Parameters for Boer Goats in South Africa (MSc dissertation, University of the Free State), citing National Dept of Agriculture data via Malan, S.W. (2000)

SYNTHETIC GRAPH SOURCE {COUNT} $&

Farm choices - continued

Use your farm observations and the research shortlists. Confirm choices locally before buying.

Animal products and care (continued)

Pigs: Pig (small-scale / emerging-farmer sow herd)

1 existing; 2 proposed structure(s). Selected enterprise: meat. No animal head count or output is assumed.

Buying advice: match breed/stock to the product, local feed, climate and care capacity; confirm with a local livestock or beekeeping adviser.

Time to first product: not sourced for this enterprise.

Age/system reference: ARC Table 1 lists pregnant sows at 10-18 L drinking water/day and lactating sows at 18-23 L/day. These are breeding-sow stages, not one amount for every pig. Farrowing care separates sow cooling from piglet warmth; outdoor systems need locally adapted hardy stock, shade and shelter. Confirm stage, reliable clean water, feed and housing locally. The manual supplies no verified edible kg per breeding sow for this plan.

Check the detailed enterprise references for feed and housing. Match the ration and space to the animal stage and housing system; provide dependable clean water.

When pigs are trucked, the SA code of practice for handling and transporting animals recommends 0.3 m² per porker, 0.4 m² per baconer and 0.8 m² per adult pig.

It is an offence to keep a pig somewhere with inadequate space, ventilation, light or shelter from heat, cold or weather, or to confine/tether it in a way that causes unnecessary suffering.

It is an offence to starve, under-feed, or deny water or food to a pig.

In heat waves, pig houses need better ventilation/airflow and lower stocking density, and outdoor pigs need shade and shelter.

African swine fever (ASF) is listed as a controlled animal disease pertaining to pigs under the Animal Diseases Act; warthogs and Ornithodorus ticks are carriers/vectors.

Foot-and-mouth disease (FMD) is also listed as a controlled animal disease pertaining to pigs under the Animal Diseases Act.

Swill (food waste) may not be fed to pigs unless it has been boiled for at least 60 minutes or sterilised by another equally effective method.

Pigs may only be moved into a biosecure compartment from another compartment that is officially certified/approved for that purpose.

A pig may not be slaughtered anywhere but a registered abattoir, except for own household consumption or cultural/religious purposes.

A pig owner must apply to register an official identification mark and mark their pigs with it, under the Animal Identification Act.

Source: Muchenje, V. & Ndou, S.P., How pig pre-slaughter welfare affects pork quality and the pig industry (Univ. of Fort Hare, hosted by SAPPO), quoting Tomlinson (2000) Code of Practice for the Handling and Transport of Livestock, p. 7

Source: Animals Protection Act 71 of 1962, s.2(1)(b), p. 1

Source: Animals Protection Act 71 of 1962, s.2(1)(c), p. 1

Source: ARC Climate-Smart Agriculture Training Manual, Module 10: Pig Production, p. 9

Source: ARC Climate-Smart Agriculture Training Manual, Module 10: Pig Production, Table 2, p. 15

Source: Munzhelele et al., Investigation of African swine fever outbreaks in pigs outside the controlled areas of South Africa, 2012-2017 (Journal of the South African Veterinary Association, SciELO SA mirror)

Source: Meat Safety Act 40 of 2000, s.7(1)(a), p. 6

Source: Animal Identification Act 6 of 2002, s.7(1), p. 4

Source: ARC Climate-Smart Agriculture: Pig production, farrowing/adaptation pp442-445, Table 1 p446, p. 446

Source: ARC Climate-Smart Agriculture Training Manual, Module 10: Pig Production, Table 1 (Water requirements of pigs, litres/pig/day), p. 10

SYNTHETIC GRAPH SOURCE {COUNT} $&

Farm choices - continued

Use your farm observations and the research shortlists. Confirm choices locally before buying.

Animal products and care (continued)

Rabbits: Meat rabbit (New Zealand White / Californian, backyard hutches)

1 existing; 2 proposed structure(s). Selected enterprise: meat. No animal head count or output is assumed.

Buying advice: match breed/stock to the product, local feed, climate and care capacity; confirm with a local livestock or beekeeping adviser.

Time to first product: not sourced for this enterprise.

Production reference: 30-35 young reaching slaughter/reproduction age/doe/year. FAO general backyard target, not a South African observed rate. The 30-35 young per doe annually have reached slaughter or reproduction age after allowance for post-weaning loss; they are not merely weaned and are not kg of meat. The source models six litters and 5.5 surviving young per litter, describing a 30-rabbit objective; an extra litter raises its stated objective to 35. Do not combine this backyard target with grower-house carcass weight from a different trial.

Productive-life reference: 0.8 years. 279 days / 365 = 0.76 years. This figure is from French INTENSIVE commercial rabbitries (average of 1992 national recording-scheme data), NOT backyard/extensive hutches - the source gives no separate productive-life figure for backyard systems (see gaps). Treat as a lower-bound / industrial-system reference only.

Age/system reference: South African grower reference: New Zealand White and Phendula rabbits in the 2017 Stellenbosch trial were slaughtered at about 11 weeks from birth. Overall means were 2.62 kg live slaughter weight, 1.55 kg hot carcass, 1.48 kg chilled carcass and 1.26 kg reference carcass with head and red offal removed, still including bones. Balanced pellets and water were freely available in a grower house. These weights are not boneless meat or annual doe output; do not multiply them by the unrelated FAO backyard target.

Check the detailed enterprise references for feed and housing. Match the ration and space to the animal stage and housing system; provide dependable clean water.

It is an offence to deny a rabbit food or water, or keep it somewhere lacking adequate space, ventilation, light or shelter from heat and cold.

Give breeding rabbits roughly 0.48-0.70 m2 of hutch floor space each, 50-60 cm high, not a cramped cage.

Rabbits are one of the domesticated animal species listed in the Meat Safety Act, so the Act's rules on abattoirs and hygiene apply to them, as they do to ducks and other listed species.

Rabbits slaughtered to be sold must be slaughtered at a registered abattoir; slaughter for the farmer's own consumption is exempt from this rule but the meat from it may not be sold.

At the abattoir, rabbits (like other listed animals) must be handled humanely during loading, transport, offloading, housing, immobilising and killing, under the Animals Protection Act.

The wild European rabbit (the same species as farmed New Zealand White/Californian rabbits) is only listed as an invasive species under NEMBA on South Africa's off-shore islands - it is not a listed/restricted species on the mainland.

Source: Animals Protection Act 71 of 1962 (consolidated text, s.2(1)(b)-(c)), p. 2

Source: FAO Animal Production and Health Series No.21 - The Rabbit: Husbandry, Health and Production (Lebas et al.), p. 172

Source: Meat Safety Act 40 of 2000, Schedule 1 (Animals to which this Act applies), p. 16

Source: Meat Safety Act 40 of 2000, s.7, p. 6

Source: Meat Safety Act 40 of 2000, s.9, p. 7

Source: South Africa's National Listed Invasive Species booklet (NEMBA Alien and Invasive Species Lists), p. 27

Source: North et al. (2019), Growth, carcass and meat quality traits of two South African meat rabbit breeds: methods p816, Table 2 p819, p. 819

Source: FAO Animal Production and Health Series No.21 - The Rabbit: Husbandry, Health and Production (Lebas et al.), p. 107

Source: FAO Animal Production and Health Series No.21 - The Rabbit: Husbandry, Health and Production (Lebas et al.), p. 201

SYNTHETIC GRAPH SOURCE {COUNT} $&

Farm choices - continued

Use your farm observations and the research shortlists. Confirm choices locally before buying.

Animal products and care (continued)

Kraal: Meat sheep (Dorper, Damara, indigenous fat-tailed and crossbred)

1 existing; 2 proposed structure(s). Selected enterprise: meat. No animal head count or output is assumed.

Buying advice: match breed/stock to the product, local feed, climate and care capacity; confirm with a local livestock or beekeeping adviser.

Time to first product: not sourced for this enterprise.

Production reference: 0.6-1.4 lambs born per ewe. outputUnit is 'lambs born/ewe/year' rather than the suggested 'kg live weight/lamb at weaning or slaughter' or 'lambs weaned/ewe/year': the source explains 'Measuring accurate lambing percentages for smallholder sheep farmers is challenging as these farmers mostly farm extensively and do not keep records', and instead calculates 'Lambs born per ewe (as recorded from the surveys based on interviews with individual respondents)' - a lambing (born), not weaning, figure, self-reported by smallholder farmers rather than measured/weighed. 139%=1.39, 83%=0.83, 61%=0.61 lambs born/ewe/year; the range [0.61, 1.39] spans the three Western Cape smallholder districts surveyed (Eden, Central Karoo, West Coast), all from this one study/quote - not merged with any other document. The same paper separately states a COMMERCIAL extensive benchmark of 110-156% lambing and 94-132% weaning (Snyman & Herselman, 2005), explicitly 'expressed over ewes joined' (a different denominator/system) - not merged into this smallholder range.

Age/system reference: The government sheep manual describes controlled breeding at Mara Research Station, Limpopo: June-July mating and November-December lambing to match rain and grass. This is one station breeding calendar, not mutton harvest months. Match adapted meat-purpose stock and feed locally, then record birth, survival, weaning and actual slaughter or sale; lambs born per ewe are not edible kg.

Check the detailed enterprise references for feed and housing. Match the ration and space to the animal stage and housing system; provide dependable clean water.

Sheep must not be penned overcrowded: at least 0.56 square metres of floor space per sheep so every animal can lie down.

Electric prodders, sticks or goads may not be used on sheep.

Sheep driven on the hoof may not be moved more than 20 km in a single day (25 km is regarded as excessive).

Livestock must be given water and fed as soon as they reach their night camp or final destination.

Injured, disabled or blind sheep must be given priority slaughter, or emergency slaughter, to prevent further pain or distress.

Foot-and-mouth disease (FMD) is a controlled animal disease under the Animal Diseases Act; Veterinary Services enforce isolation and movement restrictions.

Inside a declared FMD zone, sheep and their products cannot be moved into, out of, or within it without a state veterinary permit.

Sheep scab is a controlled disease by law: a suspected or positive case must be reported to the State Veterinarian immediately.

Against sheep scab, all small stock on the farm must be treated with a remedy registered under Act 36 of 1947, and infected sheep treated twice, eight to ten days apart.

Every sheep owner must register an official identification mark and mark their sheep with it, under the Animal Identification Act.

A sheep may be slaughtered only at an abattoir, except for the farmer's own consumption or for cultural or religious purposes.

Source: Livestock Welfare Co-ordinating Committee, Code of Practice for the Handling and Transport of Livestock (2018), s.1.2, p. 4

Source: Livestock Welfare Co-ordinating Committee, Code of Practice for the Handling and Transport of Livestock (2018), s.2.7, p. 5

Source: Livestock Welfare Co-ordinating Committee, Code of Practice for the Handling and Transport of Livestock (2018), s.3.4.1, p. 6

Source: Livestock Welfare Co-ordinating Committee, Code of Practice for the Handling and Transport of Livestock (2018), s.3.5, p. 6

SYNTHETIC GRAPH SOURCE {COUNT} $&

Farm choices - continued

Use your farm observations and the research shortlists. Confirm choices locally before buying.

Animal products and care (continued)

Kraal: Meat sheep (Dorper, Damara, indigenous fat-tailed and crossbred) (continued)

Source: Livestock Welfare Co-ordinating Committee, Code of Practice for the Handling and Transport of Livestock (2018), s.2.13, p. 5

Source: SAnews: KZN Foot and Mouth Disease boundaries extended (Dept of Agriculture statement)

Source: KZN Department of Agriculture and Rural Development, Research & Technology Bulletin 2017-18/01: Sheep Scab, p. 1

Source: KZN Department of Agriculture and Rural Development, Research & Technology Bulletin 2017-18/01: Sheep Scab, p. 3

Source: Animal Identification Act 6 of 2002, s.7(1), p. 4

Source: Meat Safety Act 40 of 2000, s.7(2)(a), p. 6

Source: DAFF: Sheep General Information Manual, Final Draft, section 3.4.6, p. 12

Source: Factors influencing off-take rates of smallholder sheep farming systems in the Western Cape Province of South Africa (South African Journal of Agricultural Extension, 47(3), 2019)

SYNTHETIC GRAPH SOURCE {COUNT} $&

Farm choices - continued

Use your farm observations and the research shortlists. Confirm choices locally before buying.

Animal products and care (continued)

Kraal: Wool sheep (Merino / Dohne Merino, incl. communal wool growers)

1 existing; 2 proposed structure(s). Selected enterprise: wool (non-food). No animal head count or output is assumed.

Buying advice: match breed/stock to the product, local feed, climate and care capacity; confirm with a local livestock or beekeeping adviser.

Time to first product: not sourced for this enterprise.

Production reference: 4-5 kg greasy wool/sheep/year. Semi-arid/extensive-veld range (4-5 kg greasy wool/sheep/year) used as the primary value; the same sentence's 8 kg/year figure is for a different system (sheep grazing CULTIVATED pastures) and is deliberately excluded from the range rather than averaged in. A Western Cape Government (Elsenburg) Dohne Merino Extensive enterprise budget (Ceres-Karoo, 2024) separately reports total flock wool sold as 4439.64 kg from a flock of '1 519' Smallstock Units, i.e. 4439.64/1519 = 2.92 kg per Smallstock Unit/year - not used as the primary value because the source does not state that 1 Smallstock Unit = 1 sheep (SSU is a standardised stock-class weighting, not a literal head count), so converting it to kg/sheep would require an unstated conversion factor. A separate NWGA/Mandela Initiative paper on the Eastern Cape communal Wool Sheep Development Program reports a Grootfontein ADI progeny-test 'Greasy fleece weight (kg) 2.8 [commercial rams] 2.4 [communal rams]' for communal Eastern Cape flocks - not merged into the primary value because that table is explicitly for '6-month old lambs' (a different life stage from a mature sheep's full annual clip), consistent with the rule against mixing figures across life stages; kept here only as EC-communal context: commercial-ram-sired lambs at 6 months averaged 2.8 kg, communal-ram-sired lambs 2.4 kg, a +16% difference.

Check the detailed enterprise references for feed and housing. Match the ration and space to the animal stage and housing system; provide dependable clean water.

Sheep must not be penned overcrowded: at least 0.56 square metres of floor space per sheep so every animal can lie down.

Electric prodders, sticks or goads may not be used on sheep.

Sheep driven on the hoof may not be moved more than 20 km in a single day (25 km is regarded as excessive).

Injured, disabled or blind sheep must be given priority slaughter, or emergency slaughter, to prevent further pain or distress.

A sheep-scab treatment plan should be in place: the disease carries a high economic and welfare cost.

Despite foot-and-mouth disease (FMD) in South Africa, wool exports continue under the inactivation clause of the OIE (World Organisation for Animal Health) rules.

Inside a declared FMD zone, sheep and their products cannot be moved into, out of, or within it without a state veterinary permit.

Sheep scab is a controlled disease by law: a suspected or positive case must be reported to the State Veterinarian immediately.

Wool from scab-infected sheep must be destroyed rather than sent to the buyer, where it would be marked as scab wool.

Every sheep owner must register an official identification mark and mark their sheep with it, under the Animal Identification Act.

A sheep may be slaughtered only at an abattoir, except for the farmer's own consumption or for cultural or religious purposes.

Source: Livestock Welfare Co-ordinating Committee, Code of Practice for the Handling and Transport of Livestock (2018), s.1.2, p. 4

Source: Livestock Welfare Co-ordinating Committee, Code of Practice for the Handling and Transport of Livestock (2018), s.2.7, p. 5

Source: Livestock Welfare Co-ordinating Committee, Code of Practice for the Handling and Transport of Livestock (2018), s.3.4.1, p. 6

Source: Livestock Welfare Co-ordinating Committee, Code of Practice for the Handling and Transport of Livestock (2018), s.2.13, p. 5

Source: KZN Department of Agriculture and Rural Development, Research & Technology Bulletin 2017-18/01: Sheep Scab, p. 3

Source: Cape Wools SA Annual Review 2020/2021, p. 8

SYNTHETIC GRAPH SOURCE {COUNT} $&

Farm choices - continued

Use your farm observations and the research shortlists. Confirm choices locally before buying.

Animal products and care (continued)

Kraal: Wool sheep (Merino / Dohne Merino, incl. communal wool growers) (continued)

Source: SAnews: KZN Foot and Mouth Disease boundaries extended (Dept of Agriculture statement)

Source: KZN Department of Agriculture and Rural Development, Research & Technology Bulletin 2017-18/01: Sheep Scab, p. 1

Source: Animal Identification Act 6 of 2002, s.7(1), p. 4

Source: Meat Safety Act 40 of 2000, s.7(2)(a), p. 6

Source: Assessing Socio-economic Factors Influencing Wool Production in Kolomana Villages of Eastern Cape, South Africa (South African Journal of Agricultural Extension), citing Bot et al., 2004

Crop varieties to check locally

Keep the named variety you actually choose. Research shortlists need confirmation for your local season, water and ground.

Tomatoes

Recorded variety: not chosen yet.

This site's climate has not resolved, so no local shortlist is claimed. Open the crop card to see sources and record your choice.